DANIEL OKAFOR-REYES

Backend Engineer | Java, Kotlin, Kafka, PostgreSQL
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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Backend engineer with professional experience building Java and Kotlin services, designing REST APIs, and working with PostgreSQL, Kafka, Docker and Kubernetes. Experienced in improving service reliability through automated testing, idempotent message processing and production incident response. Uses AWS services including EKS, S3 and SQS, and is developing Go experience through a personal CLI project. Interested in moving toward a Python-focused backend role; Python experience to date is limited to scripts and small Jenkins helpers.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Java, Kotlin; Python (scripts and small Jenkins helpers); Go (learning; personal project)
Backend and APIs: Spring Boot, REST API design, OpenAPI 3, microservices
Databases and messaging: PostgreSQL, Oracle, Kafka, RabbitMQ, Redis
Testing: Testcontainers, Spring Cloud Contract, contract testing
Cloud and infrastructure: AWS (EKS, S3, SQS), Kubernetes, Docker; Terraform (can read, has not written modules)
Other: On-call incident response, API versioning, rate limiting, transactional outbox, idempotency

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Backend Engineer | Tejo Insurance Tech *2022–Present*

- Build and maintain Java and Kotlin Spring Boot microservices, working with Kafka and Kubernetes.
- Designed a versioned OpenAPI 3 REST API for insurance brokers; added per-partner rate limiting and Spring Cloud Contract tests. The API serves 12 broker partners and around 400,000 quote requests per month.
- Resolved duplicate claim creation caused by at-least-once Kafka delivery by implementing a transactional outbox pattern and idempotency keys for consumers. Duplicate claims fell from around 40 per week to zero over the following quarter.
- Built the company's first Kotlin service, an internal Spring Boot document service that renders policy PDFs from templates, and wrote the team's Kotlin coding guidelines.
- Use AWS EKS, S3 and SQS as a service user; the platform team manages Terraform.
- Participate in an on-call rota one week per month. Handled a major Kafka lag incident in March 2024; the incident write-up was praised.
- Run the backend guild meeting every two weeks (since 2024).

Software Developer | Viajar Online *2019–2021*

- Worked on the booking and payments parts of a large Java application.
- Increased payments-module test coverage from 35% to 70% using Testcontainers, supporting safer refactoring.
- Extracted email and SMS notifications from the booking monolith into a separate Spring Boot service, using RabbitMQ for messaging and Thymeleaf for templating.

PROJECTS

OpenAPI Spec Diff CLI | Personal project

- Building a Go command-line tool to diff OpenAPI specifications.
- Approximately 600 lines; a learning project, not used in production.

CERTIFICATION

Oracle Certified Professional: Java SE 11 Developer 2020

LANGUAGES

English: Used as the working language at Tejo Insurance Tech.